AmeriCorps (Corporation for National and Community Service)

One-page brief

Priority: 30 of 33 (score 2.0). **FY2026 outlays:** $1.2B (USAspending). **As of:** 2026-10-27. Public data only.

Bottom line

AmeriCorps is small, but one of its programs has one of the highest reported error rates in government: the Foster Grandparent Program at 23.6% (FY2025). The usual problems are stipend and timesheet fraud and grantees that cannot support costs. Public data can rank grantees, not members.

Exposure

- $1.2B in outlays in FY2026.
- Foster Grandparent Program: 23.6% improper payment rate (GAO, FY2025).

Public data we can use

- **USAspending grants** to AmeriCorps grantees and subgrantees.
- **AmeriCorps OIG** reports and investigations.
- **SAM.gov** exclusions; IRS Form 990 data for nonprofit grantees.

Detection plays

1. **Grantee risk:** grantees with prior OIG findings, shared officers across grantees, or rapid growth without matching revenue.
2. **Program comparison:** grantees whose cost per member far exceeds peers.

First prototype

A grantee risk list for the Foster Grandparent and AmeriCorps State and National programs.

Limits

Member timesheets and stipend payments are not public.

Geodesic Solutions: geodesic.pro *Contact: Steve Taylor, Managing Partner: taylor@geodesic.pro*

Who to take it to

AmeriCorps Office of Grant Administration, AmeriCorps OIG.

Sources

- GAO-26-108694: FY2025 improper payments
- USAspending agency profiles (FY2026 outlays)

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